

30 SCROLL-STOPPING HOOKS

Make Them **Stop & Stay.**

30 reel openers engineered to freeze the thumb in the first second — each with the exact line, the psychology behind it, and how to film it.

Companion to your 30-Day Plan & Shooting Checklist • @mahe_r.eddits

— First, the 7 triggers that stop a scroll

Every hook below uses one of these. Learn the triggers and you can invent endless hooks of your own.

● **PATTERN INTERRUPT**

Something unexpected, weird, or loud the brain can't instantly categorise. It stops the thumb on reflex.

● **CURIOSITY GAP**

Open a clear gap between what they know and what they want to know. They stay for the reveal.

● **OPEN LOOP**

Start a story or action mid-way. The brain hates leaving things unfinished.

● **RELATABLE CALLOUT**

'That's literally me.' People can't scroll past content that is clearly about them.

● **MYTH-BUST**

Challenge a belief they hold. They stay to check whether they've been doing it wrong.

● **IDENTITY / DEFIANCE**

Us-vs-them or 'they said I couldn't.' The viewer roots for you and stays.

● **BEFORE / AFTER**

Promise a transformation or payoff. The brain commits to see how it ends.

The one rule: the hook is the **very first frame** — no "hey guys," no logo, no slow build. Start with the action or the line already happening. The first second is the only second that decides whether they watch the rest.

— Your 30 hooks

One hero hook per day, ordered to match your 30-Day Plan. The colour tag shows which trigger it pulls.

DAY 01 PATTERN INTERRUPT	
FILM	Crack a raw egg into a glass, drink it, hold a dead-serious intense face for 1 sec → hard cut.
LINE	<i>(no words — just the face)</i>
WHY	A weird, unexplained action the brain can't categorise. It HAS to keep watching to make sense of it. This is your signature.
TIP	Lock the camera, do the face longer than feels comfortable. The awkward hold is the hook.
DAY 02 OPEN LOOP	
FILM	Walk out of a gym, shaking your head, mid-sentence.
LINE	<i>"I almost quit the gym today... then this happened."</i>
WHY	An unfinished story. The brain hates open loops and stays to close it.
TIP	Start talking before the clip starts — catch yourself mid-thought, not from a clean intro.
DAY 03 RELATABLE CALLOUT	
FILM	Lying in bed, phone alarm glowing, thumb slamming snooze again and again, then freeze.
LINE	<i>"If this is your morning, watch this."</i>
WHY	Instant self-recognition — 'that's literally me.' People stay for content about themselves.
TIP	Film top-down in a dark room. Exaggerate the snooze-slaps slightly for comedy.
DAY 04 CURIOSITY GAP	
FILM	Hold up a blurred payslip / phone to the camera.
LINE	<i>"My IT salary can buy a lot — but it couldn't fix this."</i>
WHY	A clear gap between what they know and what they want to know. They stay for the reveal.
TIP	Blur the number in edit. The mystery is the point — never show real figures.
DAY 05 RELATABLE CALLOUT	
FILM	Stare blankly at your laptop, slowly take off your glasses.
LINE	<i>"POV: it's 5:59 PM Friday and the build just failed."</i>
WHY	Hyper-specific developer pain. Your core audience feels seen instantly.
TIP	Deadpan acting beats over-acting here. Let the silence sit for a beat.
DAY 06 PATTERN INTERRUPT	
FILM	First frame: a dumbbell slams the floor LOUD → sudden silence → you stare at camera.
LINE	<i>(silence, then) "Let's talk."</i>
WHY	A loud sound + abrupt silence is a physical pattern break. Thumbs stop on reflex.
TIP	The audio spike does the work. Make sure the slam is the very first frame and sound.

DAY 07

MYTH-BUST

 FILM	Point at a treadmill, shake your head 'no'.
 LINE	<i>"Stop doing endless cardio if you sit all day. Do this instead."</i>
 WHY	Challenges a common belief — viewers stay to find out if they've been wrong.
 TIP	Say it with quiet confidence, not shouting. Authority stops scrolls.

DAY 08

PATTERN INTERRUPT

 FILM	Pour a full energy drink straight down the sink.
 LINE	<i>"30 days without one of these. Here's what changed."</i>
 WHY	Wasting something on purpose is visually jarring — the brain flags it as 'wait, why?'
 TIP	Pour slowly in slight slow-mo. The 'waste' is the attention-grabber.

DAY 09

CURIOSITY GAP

 FILM	Point at your own lower back / neck with a worried face.
 LINE	<i>"Nobody warned me a desk job does THIS to your body."</i>
 WHY	Fear + curiosity combo about something that affects the viewer personally.
 TIP	Cut to a posture demo right after — deliver the payoff fast or they bounce.

DAY 10

IDENTITY / DEFIANCE

 FILM	Mid-push-up, lock eyes with the camera and pause.
 LINE	<i>"Most people quit right here. Watch."</i>
 WHY	Direct challenge + tension. They stay to see if you quit too (you don't).
 TIP	Hold the bottom of the push-up while you say it — the strain sells it.

DAY 11

CURIOSITY GAP

 FILM	Hold up two identical lunchboxes, one in each hand.
 LINE	<i>"One of these costs ₹400. One costs ₹80. Same protein."</i>
 WHY	A value gap + a number. People stay to learn which is which.
 TIP	Reveal the cheap one as the better deal — satisfying payoff.

DAY 12

BEFORE / AFTER

 FILM	Half-second flash of a Day-1 clip, then freeze on today's you.
 LINE	<i>"5 AM for 30 days. Day 1 vs Day 30."</i>
 WHY	A promised transformation. The brain commits to see the 'after'.
 TIP	Tease the after for only a frame — don't give it away in the hook.

DAY 13		PATTERN INTERRUPT
FILM	Spill protein powder all over the counter, freeze, look at camera.	
LINE	<i>"Bro... let me start over."</i>	
WHY	An unexpected 'mistake' humanises you and breaks the polished-feed pattern.	
TIP	Real or staged, keep it light. The reset line makes it rewatchable.	
DAY 14		IDENTITY / DEFIANCE
FILM	Look at the camera mid-stretch at your desk.	
LINE	<i>"Day 200 of being the only one on my team who trains."</i>	
WHY	Specific number + identity. 'Lonely discipline' is magnetic and aspirational.	
TIP	Use a believable number. Specificity feels real; round numbers feel fake.	
DAY 15		RELATABLE CALLOUT
FILM	Crack your knuckles, roll your neck, wince.	
LINE	<i>"9 hours of sitting did this to me."</i>	
WHY	Physical relatability — anyone who sits feels it in their own body.	
TIP	Cut to the fix immediately. The wince opens the loop, the fix closes it.	
DAY 16		OPEN LOOP
FILM	Sit down heavily after work, exhale.	
LINE	<i>"If you're a dev and you're tired all the time — it's NOT the code."</i>	
WHY	Reframes a problem they assumed they understood. They stay for the real reason.	
TIP	Pause after 'it's not the code' before revealing — the gap holds them.	
DAY 17		RELATABLE CALLOUT
FILM	Eat a sad desk salad, totally deadpan.	
LINE	<i>"The glow-up is not glamorous."</i>	
WHY	Honest anti-highlight-reel. Refreshing in a feed full of fake perfection.	
TIP	Flat delivery. The contrast between 'glow-up' and the sad salad is the joke.	
DAY 18		CURIOSITY GAP
FILM	Hold up 3 fingers, then 'cross out' foods with your hand.	
LINE	<i>"3 foods I quit that changed everything."</i>	
WHY	List + curiosity. People stay to check if they eat the 'bad' ones.	
TIP	Promise exactly 3 — finite lists feel watchable and shareable.	

DAY 19		IDENTITY / DEFIANCE
FILM		Walk fast toward the camera through the gym.
LINE		<i>"They said software guys can't get fit."</i>
WHY		Us-vs-them defiance. Your audience roots for you to prove 'them' wrong.
TIP		Walk INTO the lens; cut the instant you fill the frame for impact.
DAY 20		OPEN LOOP
FILM		Slam the laptop shut at 6:30 PM.
LINE		<i>"Clocked out. Now the REAL work starts." (cut to gym bag)</i>
WHY		'Real work' reframes the gym as the point — viewers stay for the twist.
TIP		The laptop-slam + bag grab in one motion keeps energy high.
DAY 21		CURIOSITY GAP
FILM		Stand next to an ice-water bowl, look skeptical.
LINE		<i>"I tried the viral 4 AM routine as an IT guy. It went badly."</i>
WHY		Trend hijack + a promised fail. 'How badly?' keeps them watching.
TIP		Lean into the comedy of it not working around a real job.
DAY 22		MYTH-BUST
FILM		Hold a measuring tape, ignore the scale behind you.
LINE		<i>"The number that matters isn't your weight."</i>
WHY		Contradicts the default belief about fitness. Curiosity to learn the 'right' number.
TIP		Glance dismissively at the scale — the visual reinforces the myth-bust.
DAY 23		OPEN LOOP
FILM		React to an off-screen question, half-smile.
LINE		<i>"My manager asked how I have energy for the gym. I told him this."</i>
WHY		Quoted dialogue opens a loop — they MUST hear the answer.
TIP		Look slightly off-camera as if recalling the moment.
DAY 24		MYTH-BUST
FILM		Hover your face over an ice bowl, then stop and look up.
LINE		<i>"Everyone does this wrong. Here's the right way."</i>
WHY		'Wrong' triggers worry + correction-seeking. Strong stop trigger.
TIP		Pause right before the plunge — the held anticipation is the hook.

DAY 25		RELATABLE CALLOUT
FILM	A Slack/notification ping sound; you freeze mid-gym-prep.	
LINE	<i>"POV: you start your fitness journey but your job has other plans."</i>	
WHY	The exact conflict every working person lives. Instant relatability.	
TIP	Use an original notification-style sound effect, not a copyrighted one.	
DAY 26		BEFORE / AFTER
FILM	Unimpressed mirror flex, shrug.	
LINE	<i>"30 days in. Honest results — no filter, no fake lighting."</i>	
WHY	Authenticity hook — promises the truth in a world of edited bodies.	
TIP	Shoot in plain light on purpose. The 'no filter' promise is the draw.	
DAY 27		PATTERN INTERRUPT
FILM	Hold a banana up to the camera like it's a phone, 'answer' it.	
LINE	<i>"Hello? Yeah, he's eating clean now."</i>	
WHY	Absurd, unexpected prop use. The brain stops to process the silliness.	
TIP	Commit fully to the bit — half-hearted absurdity falls flat.	
DAY 28		CURIOSITY GAP
FILM	Tap your temple, then point at the camera.	
LINE	<i>"The real reason you can't stay consistent isn't motivation."</i>	
WHY	Reframes a problem everyone has. They stay to learn the 'real' reason.	
TIP	Deliver slowly and let the claim breathe before you explain.	
DAY 29		OPEN LOOP
FILM	Screen-record real comments popping up, then look at camera.	
LINE	<i>"You kept asking 'how do you find time?' — so here's everything."</i>	
WHY	Payoff promise built from their own questions. Feels made-for-them.	
TIP	Blur usernames. Show 2–3 real comments stacking for proof.	
DAY 30		BEFORE / AFTER
FILM	Do the signature egg one last time → hard cut to a Day-1 vs Day-30 split.	
LINE	<i>"Remember Day 1?"</i>	
WHY	Nostalgia + payoff + signature callback. Closes the whole 30-day loop.	
TIP	The egg callback rewards anyone who followed the series from the start.	

How to use: film the FILM line, say/overlay the LINE in the first second, then cut straight into your reel. Rotate triggers so no two days feel the same — variety is what keeps a feed fresh. — Built for @mahe_r.eddits